The keeper is allowed a salary, and sells no liquor. He is old and infirm, and the prison grows evidently dirtier as he grows older. A guard of six soldiers and an officer is stationed here day and night, who are relieved every morning at eight, and do duty alternately by taking two hours trust and four repose, so that each soldier is on guard eight out of the twenty-four hours. The various edicts for regulating this prison are put into frames, and hung in the council chamber.

The execrable practice of torturing prisoners is here used, in a cellar where the horrid engine is kept. The time for it is, as in other countries, about two o'clock in the morning. A criminal suffered the Osnabrug torture twice about two years ago; the last time, at putting to him the third question (the executioner having torn off the hair from his head, breast, etc.) he confessed, and was executed. On such occasions a counsellor and secretary attend, with a doctor and surgeon, an Osnabrug executioner and sometimes the gaoler. If the criminal faints, strong salts are here applied to him, and not vinegar as in some other places.

The house of correction is a new building in an airy situation, appropriated to vagrants, children, and petty offenders. Here were ninety-four prisoners, fifty-eight of whom were children, clothed in a neat uniform of blue and white linsey-woolsey made in the house. The girls were all spinning cotton and linen. The boys, in some rooms, were carding, and spinning wool and linen, and making list shoes and carpets. In one room there were six boys (the eldest only twelve years of age) working at so many small looms for saddle girths and clothes. In two other rooms there was a number of women employed in spinning. There are also two small rooms for harder work, such as rasping logwood and hartshorn. The coverlets of all the beds had been made in the house. Besides their own clothes, etc., the prisoners here make girths, slippers, and list carpets for sale, specimens of which I brought with me. The orders for regulating the hours of work, learning, recreation, etc., were hung up in the schoolroom. Both old and young were neat and clean; and everything in the house appeared quiet and orderly.

This institution, of only two years' standing, does great honour to the founder and director, Mr. Burgomaster Alemann, and is the best monument that can ever be erected for him. A good choice has been made of proper persons to preside, and inspect; which is a circumstance of the greatest importance in such houses.

BRUNSWICK. The workhouse, or house of correction, stands near the river that runs through the city. In October 1781, there were here about seventy prisoners, who are always locked up. On the first and second floors the men and women sleep in boxes in the passages. In the workrooms (it being Sunday) I was much surprised to find them all (except some lunatics in chains) employed in carding and spinning. This accounted for the keeper's preventing me from seeing them at chapel, by saying no person was admitted. I was however admitted after the service, and concluded from the sand on the floor at the prisoners' benches, that few or none had attended. My conductor insisted on carrying a pan of charcoal through the rooms; but his fumigation could not overcome the offensiveness of this dirty house.

HARBURG. At Harburg there were thirteen slaves working on the fortifications, with irons on one leg, and chains supported by girdles round their waists. Their allowance is three halfpenny worth of ammunition bread, and five farthings a day. They are guarded by soldiers, who have orders to fire on them if they attempt to escape. But, notwithstanding this, when the Elbe was frozen over (1780) five escaped to Hamburg.

HAMBURG. In the great and opulent city of Hamburg in 1776, I visited all the prisons with every advantage, through the kindness of my friend, Senator Voght. In the Büttuley the felons were all in irons. The common method of execution is decollation. The executioner (who is gaoler) showed me the sword kept for this purpose, telling me he had made use of it eight times. Here is no courtyard, and only one day-room on the ground floor. Above stairs, there are six or eight strong rooms about ten feet square. Allowance for each prisoner is four marks a week (a mark 1s. 3d.). Divine service is constantly performed on Sundays and Thursdays. In 1781, there were only two criminals and one debtor. I saw them at chapel, and they seemed very attentive and much affected. The prison was clean: but I perceived by the countenance of the gaoler and his unwillingness to show me again the torture-room, that he had seen my publication. For among the various engines of torture, or the question, which I have seen in France, Italy, Germany, and other places, one of the most excruciating is kept and used in a deep cellar of this prison. It ought to be buried ten thousand fathoms deeper.[1] It is said the inventor

[1] See the Marquis Beccaria, chap. xvi, *Of Torture.*